Thursday, 1 January 2026 — בית חוניו and the Possibility of Bringing קרבנות Today

Independent review · read fresh, from the finished HTML only (as delivered, before part-3 corrections) · 1 November 2026

1.Overall Read

A thirteen-section write-up (roughly 4,300 words of body plus a twenty-five-note *Mareh Mekomos* apparatus) of a shiur that begins with *Beis Chonyo* and turns, in Section V, to the attempt to restore *korbanos* in modern times. The arc is clear and the second half is the stronger: the Rambam/Ra'avad dispute on *kedushah rishonah* (VI), its consequence for the Temple Mount (VII), Kalischer's "either way" argument (VIII), Rav Kook's answer (IX), the precedent of Rabbeinu Yechiel (XI), the list of obstacles (XII) and Rav Kook's close (XIII). The hard editorial issues are six: (a) the sentence that Kalischer was a student of "the Vizhnitzer rebbe" sits beside a footnote that says it is probably wrong, and Section X gives the teacher as the Kovno Rav, who was a generation younger; (b) in Section XII three speakers are blurred ("Rabbi Shimon Sofer writes to his son-in-law (the כבוד)"); (c) several names appear that look like transcription errors (חיים זנוויל, שירא שולר, גראדנא); (d) the voice of oral delivery ("Last Thursday," "I am a bit Satmar," "Thank you very much for coming"); (e) working notes left in the apparatus ("Verify exact סימן," "verify exact author and edition"); and (f) a date for Ishtori ("the end of the 1200s") that disagrees with the dates in fn 17.

2.What Works

- **The turn in Section V.** "Why קרבן פסח specifically?" is answered with one practical fact: every קרבן ציבור needs the whole people to contribute,

and an “adopt a קרבן” campaign is not in the picture. Real Torah in a few lines.

- **The Rambam on the שכינה (VI).** “The שכינה may exile us, but the שכינה did not exile itself” is the best sentence in the document and is rightly set off with its verse.
- **VIII, the logic of Kalischer.** The either-way argument (Rambam: bring a קרבן; Ra’avad: build a במה) is stated in six sentences and a reader can restate it.
  - **The Rabbeinu Yechiel story (XI).** The sequence of the apostate student, the burning, the move, and Ishtori’s forgotten question is well paced; the line “I was so excited by the very idea that I forgot to ask” earns its place.
- **The list of obstacles (XII).** A good, scannable set of subheadings; the ציץ → כהן גדול → סנהדרין chain is the clearest passage in the piece.
  - **Footnote hygiene.** Twenty-five notes in body order with matching back-links; the Hebrew-inline convention is consistent, and two notes use the longer “academic note” form.

3.Where It’s Weak or Could Be Sharper

Section V and fn 11 disagree. The body: Kalischer was “a תלמיד of the Vizhnitzer rebbe.” Fn 11: this is “a likely transcription error; Kalischer was a תלמיד of R’ Akiva Eiger and the חותם סופר.” A published text cannot carry its own correction; the body should be fixed and the note should say what the source says.

Section X cannot be right as written. It says that before publishing his ספר (1861), Kalischer was a תלמיד of יצחק אלחנן ספקטור מקובנא and wrote to him. The Kovno Rav (fn 16: 1817–1896) was twenty-two years younger than Kalischer (fn 11: 1795–1874) and could not have been his teacher. The same section places Gutmacher “of גרודנא (Grodno), while Gutmacher is known

as the *Tzaddik of Greiditz*. Later, Section XII has רבי אברהם דוד אוערבאך as the sage who said "show me הלכה" to his student, and הרב שירא שולר rejecting "his דרוש words." Nowhere is this student introduced. The exchange only makes sense if the teacher is the one who refused Kalischer in Section X, and the student is Kalischer. A reader cannot follow it.

The חתם סופר paragraph (XII) blurs three speakers. "רבי חיים זנוויל wrote that… רבי שמעון סופר writes to his son-in-law (the בעל חתם סופר) 'you are an old man living in Europe…' רבי צבי פסח פרנק says the same." The quoted words are addressed to an "old man living in Europe," yet Shimon Sofer (a grandson of the חתם סופר) is described as writing to his own father-in-law. The paragraph needs: who writes, to whom, and when. Also the paragraph contains the whole of Kalischer's plan (the כותל, אבן השתייה, משנה תמיד, מסכת מידות letters to the Ottoman authorities) in two sentences: the plan deserves a short paragraph of its own, since its absurdity is the point.

Ishtori's century. The body says "At the end of the 1200s — in the transition between ראשונים and אחרונים — lived רבי אשתורי הפרחי." Fn 17 says c. 1280–1355 and that he "toured the land in the early 14th century." Moreover Rabbeinu Yechiel is placed c. 1260–1270 and Ishtori is said to have met his student's student; the dates need to line up. Also, as the section runs, it is not clear whether Ishtori (or the lecturer) is the one who "immediately reasons" that Rabbeinu Yechiel relied on מאה הותרה בציבור and in XII "רבי אשתורי writes 'הותרה' but according to the Rambam that is not correct" makes Ishtori the author of a ruling he was not in a position to give.

The voice. The text moves between a sefer voice and the lecturer. "Last Thursday we discussed…," "I would love a historian to discover…," "I am part of the דעת רוב" my wife's grandfather," "(and I am a bit Satmar, but I will read his words honestly — he is allowed)," "Anyone learning בחים has been through it," and "Thank you very much for coming." For a printed edition these need either a speaker label ("the Rav") or removal; the Satmar remark in particular is a quip that reads as a stance when written down.

The pushback in Section III has no speaker. "Pushed back: but שמות are forbidden as long as the בית המקדש stands" — pushed back by whom? The

text reads as the lecturer answering himself, which makes the שדוש of the תורת חיים book refuted in the same breath. Either attribute it (a question from the room) or recast the section as objection and answer.

Section VII is political by implication. It says “I do not want to make this political” and then characterizes who goes up, who is “really ארצי שמים” and which camps do not go. The material is accurate to the shiur but, in print, needs a more neutral frame (“the Rav notes that…”).

The ending. “And that ended the conversation, until today” is clear. But Section XIII ends with the שיור aside promising another day. The conclusion should say what the piece has not covered (the remaining halachic problems), which the text now leaves to the reader.

4.Factual / Citation Concerns

Fn 7 (תורת חיים)	The note gives “	Lublin/Belz, ר’ חיים בן שמואל שור
1572–1632” while the body says “	and ends with a working ר’ חיים שור	
note, “Verify exact	quotation against the printed *Toras Chaim*.” The author	
of the *Toras Chaim* on	and	is generally cited as ר’ אברהם קמא
Avraham Chaim Schor; check the name and dates, and remove the note.		

Fn 11. “Lyssa, 1862” for the place; the title given (“	דרישת ציון וחברת ארץ
ושבת) is not the title in the body. The body says 1861 and the note	

1862, with no remark. The claim that he “corresponded with the Rothschild and Montefiore families, with R’ Akiva Eiger, and with the חתם סופר family on the practical question” is uncited and goes beyond the shiur.

Fn 16. Ends with “verify exact letter in printed ת"שו collections (*Be’er Yitzchak*, *Ein Yitzchak*)” — a working note, and the two works named are by the Kovno Rav; if the teacher is Akiva Eiger these are the wrong books.

Fn 12. “ד רל"ו and ח ר"ג אע"ג with the statement that the חתם סופר is “generally cautious but supportive in principle.” The body says he “is uncertain.” The note should not claim more than the text.

Fn 13. “ו הט"ו-הט"ז פ", while the body (VI and XIII) says the Rambam

writes “at the beginning of	ה״לכות בית הבחירה Chapter 6 is not the

beginning. Also the quotation in the note, “	קדשה לשעתה וקדשה לעתיד

ל״בוא should be checked against the halachah.

Fn 20. “The ם"	במ paskens	ויוה the ש"	אא and others	ה״נתרה

Uncited; the Rosh is a surprising name here. Also “set aside *bedieved*”

for	ויוחו is a loose gloss (the body says	לכתחילה me seeks a pure

כהן

Fn 22. The note itself says “Verify exact author and edition; possible

candidates include….” A working note in the published apparatus, and the

body gives the author as just	חיים נתן

Fn 24. “	ד m ולחם שמים"	משנה ידים פ is not obviously the place for the

Yaavetz’s remark on the genealogy of	והנים the text should say

where. The body says the Yaavetz “writes long before Kalischer: *show me one* שהן *with letters*” (a quotation without a source).

Fn 8 and fn 10. Fn 8 says the Mishnah “records this as a” שיבוח “and then “criticizes” the families — contradictory. Fn 10 dates the *Targum Sheni* “perhaps 7th–8th century” and says the shiur “uses it as evidence that Alexandria was the center of artisanry,” but the shiur only says “perhaps.”

Fn 3 vs. body. The body says the מראה of מנחות gives the verse (Isa. 19:19) as Chonyo’s justification; the note says the מראית rejects this reading.” Which? The body only says no one knows its פשט

5.Small Polish Suggestions

- The name appears as חוניו everywhere except one subheading, which has “Chonio” in Latin letters; make it uniform.

- “Yidden,” “yid,” “אגב,” “Tom, Dick, and Harry” — pick a register.
- Subheadings in XII mix English and Hebrew (“טומאה הותרה or דחויה?”; “ארגמן”; “The Exact Place of the מזבח”); make them parallel.
  - The footnote form is inconsistent: some notes are “short + expanded,” others “short + Note.” Use one.
- The Djerba paragraph ends on DNA with no conclusion; add the halachic point (the question of חללים) in a clause.
  - The lead says the piece will answer “what it would actually take,” and the answer arrives in XII as a list; one sentence of synthesis at the end of XII would help.

6.Bottom Line

> *A readable, well-ordered write-up with a very good second half. It needs one mechanical pass (the teacher of Kalischer, the Section X attribution, the three blurred speakers, the Ishtori dates, the garbled names), one clean-up of the apparatus (remove four working notes, harmonize the Rambam reference), and a decision about voice. With those done it can stand as a sefer chapter.*

Produced by an independent editorial pass reading the finished HTML only, without the transcripts. Reviewer brings the perspective of a learned general reader familiar with the standard *Gemara* in *Menachos* and *Zevachim* and the Rambam’s *Mishneh Torah*.